REPORT

Task-1:

For the visual component of this project, I designed a comprehensive infographic titled **"Digital Success Guide for Students."** To create this, I used **Canva**, that allowed me to maintain a professional yet engaging aesthetic.

The infographic is strategically divided into three core pillars of digital literacy:

- **Useful Digital Tools:** I highlighted essential software like Google Workspace for collaboration, Notion for organization, and Grammarly for academic writing.
- **Safe Internet Practices:** This section emphasizes "cyber hygiene," such as creating complex passwords and being skeptical of phishing attempts to protect personal data.
- **Professional Email Etiquette:** I outlined the anatomy of a proper email, focusing on clear subject lines and professional sign-offs.

One thing I found particularly interesting during the design process was the **balance between information density and visual hierarchy**. It was a great exercise in simplifying complex advice into actionable, bite-sized "pro-tips" that stick with the reader.

Task-2:

I've set up profiles on **LinkedIn, GitHub, and HackerRank** to build a solid professional foundation. Each serves a unique purpose in my growth over the next four years.

Platform Breakdown

- **LinkedIn:** My "digital resume." I'll use this to network with seniors and track industry trends.

- **GitHub:** My "code portfolio." This is where I'll host my semester projects. It's not just for storage; it's a way to prove to future employers that I can actually build functional software.
- **HackerRank:** My "training gym." I plan to use this for weekly coding practice. It's the best way to keep my problem-solving skills sharp so I'm ready when technical interviews eventually roll around.

Future Plan

My goal is to update these platforms in real-time rather than scrambling to fill them during my final year. By 2029, I want these profiles to tell the story of a student who was proactive, technically curious, and ready for the industry.

Task-3:

For the digital skills part of my project, I dove into **HackerRank** and **Google Workspace**.

I started on **HackerRank** by knocking out the **Arithmetic Operators** challenge. It felt good to get that first "Success" message! While it's a basic task, it's the first step in building the muscle memory I'll need for technical interviews later.

On the collaboration side, I built a **Digital Literacy Quiz** using **Google Forms**. Seeing the responses pop up in a linked **Google Sheet** was a real "lightbulb moment" for me. It showed me exactly how I can manage data for group projects or even college club events without getting overwhelmed by manual entry.

These tools really bridge the gap between just "studying" and actually "doing." I'm excited to keep refining these skills as I move through my degree.

Task-4:

A common situation where poor communication causes real problems is the "Casual Email Trap." I've seen cases where students treat emails to professors or recruiters like a quick WhatsApp text—using slang, no subject line, or skipping a professional sign-off. In one instance, a student lost an internship

because their email was so informal (*"hey, r u still taking interns??"*) that the recruiter assumed they weren't serious about the role and didn't even bother opening their resume.

What could have been done differently? The student should have treated the email as their first "digital handshake." By using a clear subject line, a respectful greeting, and proofreading for tone, they would have shown that they respect the recipient's time. Professionalism online isn't just about following rules; it's about building trust. A well-structured email proves you have the "soft skills" needed to represent a company or a department effectively.

Task-5:

What surprised me most during my research into **UPI and Phishing fraud** was just how much these scams rely on "human hacking" rather than "computer hacking." I always thought cybercrime involved complex coding or breaking through firewalls, but in reality, most attackers just use a sense of urgency or fear to make us skip our own logic. Learning that a simple "Request Money" notification on a UPI app can be disguised so easily to look like a "Refund" was a huge eye-opener. It's a reminder that being technically skilled doesn't make you immune to being tricked.

One habit I will personally change as a result of this task is my "click-first" mentality. I've realized that I often scan QR codes or click on links in my university groups without a second thought. From now on, I'm adopting a "Zero Trust" approach: I will manually verify any payment request and never enter my UPI PIN unless I am the one intentionally sending money. Staying safe is clearly more about slowing down than it is about having the best antivirus software.